

Leave Policy

Enterprise Leave Policy for All Employees

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TCI-HR-POL-001

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01-Apr-2026

Owner: Human Resources
Department

1. Purpose and Scope

This policy defines the leave entitlements, eligibility, approval process, and administrative rules applicable to all permanent employees of TechCorp India across all office locations. It applies from the date of joining, subject to the probation rules outlined in Section 5. Leave for contractors and interns is governed separately under their respective engagement terms and is not covered by this document.

The leave year follows the financial year (1 April to 31 March). All entitlements below are stated on a pro-rata, calendar-year basis unless otherwise specified.

2. Leave Types and Entitlements

TechCorp India provides the following categories of leave. Entitlements accrue on a pro-rata monthly basis for employees joining mid-year, calculated from the date of joining.

Leave Type	Annual Entitlement	Accrual Rate	Key Conditions
Casual Leave (CL)	12 days/year	1 day/month	For short personal matters; max 3 consecutive days without manager pre-approval
Sick Leave (SL)	10 days/year	0.83 days/month	For illness or medical appointments; 3+ consecutive days require a medical certificate
Earned/Privilege Leave (EL)	18 days/year	1.5 days/month	Accrues and can be carried forward (see Section 3.1); used for planned vacation
Maternity Leave	26 weeks (182 days)	Granted in full on approval	As per the Maternity Benefit Act, 1961 (amended); applicable for up to 2 surviving children
Paternity Leave	10 working days	Granted in full on approval	To be availed within 3 months of child's birth/adoption
Bereavement Leave	5 working days	Granted in full on approval	For death of immediate family (spouse, parent, child, sibling, parent-in-law)
Compensatory Off (Comp-Off)	Earned basis	1 day per qualifying weekend/holiday worked	Must be availed within 60 days of accrual or it lapses
Leave Without Pay (LWP)	As approved	Not accrued	Applicable when other leave balances are exhausted; subject to manager and HR approval

3. Accrual, Carry Forward, and Encashment Rules

3.1 Earned Leave (EL)

- Accrues at 1.5 days per completed month of service
- Up to 45 days may be carried forward to the next leave year; any balance above 45 days as of 31 March is automatically encashed at the employee's current basic salary rate

- Encashment is processed in the April payroll cycle following year-end

3.2 Casual Leave (CL) and Sick Leave (SL)

- CL does not carry forward; unused CL lapses on 31 March each year
- SL carries forward up to a maximum balance of 20 days; no encashment applicable
- CL and SL cannot be combined to extend a single leave block beyond 5 consecutive days without Director-level approval

3.3 Comp-Off

Comp-off is granted only for pre-approved weekend or public holiday work, confirmed in writing by the manager in advance. It must be availed within 60 calendar days of the date earned; unused comp-off lapses without encashment.

4. Approval Process and Hierarchy

All leave requests are submitted through the HR Information System (HRIS) and follow a structured approval hierarchy. The specific path depends on leave type and duration.

Approval Stage	Role and Action
Employee	Submits leave request in HRIS with type, dates, and reason; for SL of 3+ days, uploads medical certificate
Reporting Manager	Reviews against team workload and project commitments; approves or rejects within 2 business days for planned leave
HR	Validates leave balance, confirms compliance with blackout periods (Section 6), and processes statutory leave types (maternity, paternity, bereavement) directly
VP / Department Head	Required for: leave exceeding 10 consecutive days, LWP requests, CL+SL combinations beyond 5 days, and any leave during a declared blackout period

Standard path: Employee → Reporting Manager → HR (for record & balance update). **Extended path** (applies for LWP, long leave, or blackout-period requests): Employee → Reporting Manager → VP/Department Head → HR.

Emergency leave (e.g., sudden illness, family emergency) may be informed verbally or via message to the manager on the day of absence, with formal HRIS entry completed within 2 business days of returning to work.

5. Probation Period Leave Rules

New employees are typically on probation for the first 6 months from date of joining, extendable as per individual offer terms. Leave rules during probation differ from confirmed employee entitlements as follows.

- Casual Leave and Sick Leave accrue from the date of joining at the standard monthly rate and may be availed during probation
- Earned Leave accrues during probation but may only be availed after successful confirmation, except in genuine emergencies with VP approval
- Maternity, paternity, and bereavement leave are available from day one of employment regardless of probation status, as these are statutory entitlements
- Unapproved or excessive absence during probation may be considered during the confirmation review and can affect confirmation timelines
- LWP during probation requires HR and VP joint approval and may extend the probation period by an equivalent duration

6. Blackout Periods

Blackout periods are timeframes where planned leave (excluding statutory and emergency leave) requires additional VP-level approval due to business-critical activity. Blackout periods are announced by HR in coordination with department heads at least 30 days in advance.

Blackout Period	Typical Window	Affected Teams
Financial Year-End Close	15–31 March	Finance, Accounts, and reporting-linked roles
Quarter-End Close	Last 5 working days of each quarter	Finance, Sales Operations
Major Client Go-Lives / Releases	As declared per project	Assigned project/delivery teams only
Annual Audit Window	Typically June–July (dates vary)	Finance, Compliance, Internal Audit

Statutory leave (maternity, paternity, bereavement) and genuine medical emergencies are never denied during a blackout period. Blackout restrictions apply only to discretionary planned leave such as Earned Leave and Casual Leave.

7. Additional Provisions

7.1 Public Holidays

TechCorp India observes a list of national, festival, and regional holidays published annually by HR by 31 December for the following calendar year, with a minimum of 12 holidays per location. Employees may optionally swap up to 2 regional/festival holidays for alternate days with manager approval, where local office practice allows.

7.2 Leave During Notice Period

Earned Leave balance may be utilized during the notice period subject to manager approval and knowledge transfer completion. Unused Earned Leave at the time of exit is encashed as part of full and final settlement; CL and SL are not encashed on exit.

7.3 Adoption Leave

Employees adopting a child below the age of 3 months are eligible for 12 weeks of adoption leave, administered on the same approval terms as maternity leave.

7.4 Leave Encashment on Confirmation

No leave encashment is processed at the point of probation confirmation; encashment applies only at year-end (Section 3.1) or full and final settlement (Section 7.2).

8. Leave Misuse and Non-Compliance

Scenario	Action
Frequent unapproved absence (3+ instances/quarter)	Documented manager counselling; HR notification
Falsified medical certificate	Disciplinary action per HR Conduct Policy; may include termination
Leave taken during blackout without approval	Marked as LWP retroactively; formal warning
Continued absence beyond approved leave without communication	Treated as unauthorized absence; may lead to disciplinary proceedings

9. Contact Information

Contact Point	Team / Name	Email	Phone	Availability
HR Helpdesk (General Queries)	HR Operations Team	hr.helpdesk@techcorpindia.com	+91 80 4567 1000	Mon–Fri, 9:30–18:30 IST
Leave & Attendance Desk	HR Shared Services	leave.admin@techcorpindia.com	+91 80 4567 1005	Mon–Fri, 9:30–18:00 IST
Statutory Leave (Maternity/Paternity)	HR Business Partner Team	hrbp.statutory@techcorpindia.com	+91 80 4567 1008	Mon–Fri, 10:00–18:00 IST
Payroll & Encashment Queries	Payroll Team	payroll@techcorpindia.com	+91 80 4567 1012	Mon–Fri, 9:30–18:30 IST
VP — Human Resources	Priya Nataraj	priya.nataraj@techcorpindia.com	+91 98455 67210	Escalation only, via HRBP

This policy is reviewed annually by Human Resources or upon statutory change to applicable labour law. In case of conflict between this document and applicable law, statutory provisions prevail. Last reviewed: April 2026. Next scheduled review: April 2027.